

You Found a Baby Rabbit

How you handle the baby will determine whether it survives or not, so please continue reading.

Cottontail rabbits are prey animals, meaning everything bigger will kill it and eat it. They are programmed to be terrified of everything and WE ARE PREDATORS. How it is handled, what you put it in, where you put it and how long it takes you to find a rehabilitator is all crucial for its survival.

They are only in the nest for approximately 3-4 weeks. They venture out and stay around for about a week. So, in this case size matters.

FIRST - From a distance, check its size.

SIZE - 5" - 6" inches nose to tail. Fully furred and ears erect. - Or, God forbid you are holding it and it completely fits in your hand.....LEAVE IT ALONE or put it back. They have just left the nest and will be fine. Is it alone or with other siblings? Sitting up or laying on its side? In harm's way? Injured? Blood? Any dead? Shriveled stomach vs a round tummy. Eyes open around 12 days. They can run if feel threatened.

HAS THE NEST BEEN DISTURBED? Put a laundry basket over it with a brick. Must be removed early morning and at dusk for mom.

PICKING IT UP - Have a box with a blanket in it already. **WITHOUT TALKING**, put the baby in the box and cover with a thin towel. Then put the baby somewhere **DARK AND QUIET BEFORE you call a rehab centre**. No children or pets near the baby.

CAPTURE MYOPATHY - As with birds and fawns, rabbits can die of stress! "Capture myopathy threatens wildlife populations. It is a primary cause of death in wild animals undergoing human handling, leading to high mortality rates during and after capture."

NO FOOD OR WATER - They have a complex digestive system.

TRANSPORTING - Keep it in the secure container. Please no radio and minimal talking.



10-12 days old

4 weeks -weaned